It became clear: Levin threatened to resign if Herzog's compromise was accepted, and threatened, moreover, to take Smotrich and Ben-Gvir with him. Netanyahu gave in. The PM is most probably in the hands of the worst of our fanatics. Ben-Gvir demands the attorney general's dismissal.

Demonstrations in Tel Aviv and scuffles with the police and some ultras. In Jerusalem, demonstrators, disguised as municipal workers, marked out a red line from the central police compound through city streets to the Supreme Court, with an inscription in Hebrew, Arabic, and English: "Drawing the Line." The police arrested five of the "workers."

Army operation in Jenin. Four Palestinians killed.

Former Israeli prime minister Ehud Olmert asks world leaders to shun Netanyahu.

Friday, March 17

Shabtai to Ben-Gvir: "The police will remain apolitical and act only according to the law." Ben-Gvir will throw one of his usual tantrums and threaten the police commander. Shabtai should find full support among his officers.

Inscription on Justice Minister Levin's house, while he sits *shiva* (mourning) for his father: "Levin is an enemy of the people." The inscription has been denounced by both the coalition and the opposition.

From Sunday on, about 750 reserve officers from the air force, intelligence, and special forces will not report for call-ups.

First Arab demonstration in Israel, in Kafr Manda, an Arab village in the Galilee. The organizer, at the head of some 250 participants, declared: "The ratification of the overhaul will cause irreversible damage to the Arabs in the country."

In Israel, the present situation is often compared to the Yom Kippur crisis of October 1973, the surprise attack of the Egyptians and Syrians